wish upon a shooting star

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31789018.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by novaartinoisaqueen

Summary

slow days at work are the worst, but sometimes, they're not so bad when an attractive customer comes in.

or, adora is a college student who works part time at a small fragrance store. when a ridiculously hot person comes in during a slow day, adora forgets how to function (and her coworkers tease her relentlessly for it).

Notes

I went to bath and body works a few weeks ago after not having been for a while and this was born. I forgot it existed so I'm posting now lol

For those who don't know, bath and body works is a fragrance store that sells body care (perfume, body spray, lotion, shower gel, etc) and home fragrances (candles, plug-ins, room sprays, car fresheners). It's a relatively small store (boutique style) with display tables throughout and shelves lining the walls. If you're interested in what it looks like, you can google it. While adora doesn't work there, her workplace is heavily influenced by it.

See the end of the work for more notes

For a Friday afternoon, it was a slow day at work. Usually, Mystacor Fragrances would be packed by now with the after school and after work crowds. It wasn't like they had been doing poorly lately—they won an award from the city less than two months ago for being the best fragrance store in Etheria. Adora blamed the weather, chilly and wet despite it being early May; it had been raining for most of the day and showed no signs of letting up. Still, it was Friday afternoon, which, rain or shine, meant it was the weekend.

Sighing, Adora retrieved another refill box from the cart set up in the back of the store and headed to their soap section. This was what she had been doing for most of her shift since she got there at two in the afternoon. Now it was nearing five o'clock, and she was running out of products to refill. Refilling, as boring as it was, was more entertaining than simply walking circles around the store looking for something to straighten up.

There were a couple customers in the store, but Glimmer was on selling duty today and Bow was on greeting duty, so they were the customers' first point of contact. Adora, meanwhile, was on register duty.

She didn't mind the register, really, but she preferred to be out on the floor, talking to people and selling products. On busy days, being on the register wasn't too bad because she still got to talk to a lot of people, but on days like today, she would do anything to get away from it. A few customers had asked her questions while she was restocking, and she had checked on some as she passed by them, but other than that, she was left alone, and she was dying inside.

At the front of the store, Bow greeted a new customer. Adora peeked over from where she was kneeling in front of one of the overstock drawers and nearly dropped the soap bottle in her hand, a popular fragrance from their summer collection that was brought back every year.

Her day just got a lot more interesting, because the person that just walked in was drop dead gorgeous, probably the most beautiful person Adora had ever seen. She watched, soap forgotten, as they conversed with Bow, who led them over to the candles after a moment. Once he left them to shop alone, Adora raised her walkie mic to her lips. She was probably going to get an eye roll from her manager for not using the equipment for its intended purpose—keeping up with everyone else around the shop and getting things done more efficiently—but she had been there for two years, and her manager liked her; besides, it wasn't like they hadn't used the walkies for non-work reasons before on slow days.

"What's the new customer shopping for?" she asked, looking right at Bow so he would know it was for him. He glanced over at her and raised his eyebrows almost knowingly.

"Candles," Bow replied into his mic curtly, then added with a small, teasing smirk, *"but I'm sure the salesperson of the month could talk her into a new girlfriend."*

Adora's face heated up instantly. She was the salesperson of the month. Before she got a chance to respond to Bow, her earpiece crackled.

"Adora, just because it's a slow day, doesn't mean you can be a useless lesbian," came Glimmer's chiding voice. If Adora could see her, she would glare at the girl.

"I hate you guys," she settled for, immediately returning to her soap restocking before another coworker could make fun of her.

When her box was empty, she collapsed it and went to retrieve another one. Peeking across the store, she noticed the breathtaking customer had drifted over to body sprays and lotions. Oh, look at that, there was a restock box for A Million Dreams lotion. Guess she had to get closer to the customer now.

Adora went for nonchalant as she carried her box to that side of the store, setting it down on the counter and reaching for her box cutters in her apron. The customer was about five feet away, and wow, she was prettier up close. Adora tried not to stare too much at her tattoos or jewelry that decorated her body, but it was hard when this person was so attractive.

Normally, Adora was drawn to more muscular people—this person was toned and had visible muscle for sure, but she wasn't the bodybuilder type Adora tended to drool over—but there was something about her that had Adora flustered.

A Million Dreams. Right.

Adora began pulling out lotion bottles and pushing them onto the shelf, lining them up nice and neat. Presentation was everything, after all. On top of being well-liked for their variety of fragrances and good products, customers seemed to appreciate the aesthetic of the store, how clean and organized it always was.

Once the shelf was full, she kneeled down and opened the overstock drawer for the remaining bottles. The drawer was a bit of a mess compared to the rest of the store, but it wasn't like anyone but the workers saw them. On occasion, a nosy person would learn that there were cabinets and drawers beneath the displays, that they weren't just decoration, but a worker was always nearby to nicely redirect their attention.

As she stocked the drawer, she peeked over at the customer, immersed in her own shopping. There was a plain satchel hanging from her shoulder; it was hard not to notice the buttons and hanging decorations on it. Adora recognized the names of a few bands, smiled at her "fuck the patriarchy" and progress pride flag keychains, and felt her mouth go dry at the heart-shaped lesbian pride flag button. She also noticed a keychain for the University of Horde, a school in the area, and also Bright Moon University's—where Adora went—biggest rival, mostly because they were within an hour of one another.

“What’s your favorite scent?”

Adora nearly jumped at the voice above her, distracted by the satchel. Looking up, her crush was staring down at her, lip curled up in a tiny, mischievous smile that had no business causing butterflies to stir in Adora’s stomach.

“I’m sorry, what?” she replied, even though she heard exactly what the customer said.

The smile only stretched. “What’s your favorite scent? Anything you recommend?”

Adora’s mind blanked for a moment, despite having a decent knowledge of all the scents in the store. She clawed through her brain for something, scanning the shelves of products for inspiration. “Shooting Star,” she said finally, eyes landing on the fragrance. “I’m not normally one for favorites, but I love it.” It was true—she used a number of products with that scent. It wasn’t the most popular, and it wasn’t a customer favorite, but Adora really liked its vibrancy.

Standing, Adora reached for one of the body sprays and a tester card. She spritzed the card, waving it back and forth a little before passing it to the customer.

“Mm,” she said after a moment, sniffing the card and looking at Adora with a short, but enthusiastic, nod. “Fruity.”

The way she said it, eyeing Adora up and down with her smirk, brought heat to the back of Adora’s neck.

Adora swallowed thickly. “Uh, yeah.” Clearing her throat, she tacked on, just to try and sound professional, “All body care is buy three get three free right now. My name is Adora if you need anything, and your name is—?”

“Catra,” she replied. “That’s a pretty name, Adora.”

Again, Adora was immediately flustered. “Thank-thank you.” Damn stutter. “It was nice meeting you, Catra.”

“Likewise. Thanks for your help,” Catra said sweetly, definitely not in the way customers normally sounded when they were just being polite. She sounded genuine, yet almost sly about it, which did nothing to help Adora’s embarrassing blush.

Catra stepped around Adora, *winking* at her as she reached for a Shooting Star lotion and placed it in the small shopping basket hooked on her arm.

Adora watched as she walked away, and if she was gaping a little bit, that was no one’s business but her own, thank you. Her mouth felt dry, but there was no way she was going to step into the backroom for two minutes to get a sip of water and potentially miss the opportunity to check Catra out—at the register, not as a lesbian.

“You okay over there, Adora?” one of her coworkers, Hannah, asked over the walkies. Across the store, Adora caught Bow’s shoulders shaking with what must’ve been laughter.

“Fine,” Adora huffed in response before returning to her original task. There was no possible way she would be able to get her face back to a normal color at this point.

Once she was finished restocking that scent, she made her way back to the restock cart to grab another box, only to see Catra hovering near the checkout, void of cashiers. She was looking at their hand sanitizers, but Adora had seen far too many customers busy themselves with the same thing while they waited to check out.

Maybe being put on registers today was a good thing.

“Are you ready?” she asked as she walked over to her, hoping that she didn’t sound too eager. Catra flashed her that same smile from earlier, a smile that Adora’s mother would usually say meant no good, and she nodded.

“Awesome!” Adora flinched inwardly at her perkiness. Normally, that was how she spoke with customers, but Catra was different. Somehow, Adora got the vibe that perkiness drew her away, and that was the last thing Adora wanted.

“Did you find everything alright?” she added once she was behind the register and accepting Catra’s basket.

“Almost,” Catra replied casually, almost sounding bored as she busied herself with checking out the items on display at the counter.

Adora blinked at her. “Oh! Well, what else were you looking for? I could help you if you aren’t ready to check out yet.”

The look she received was practically dripping in amusement. “I was looking for this fragrance called Your Number, but I was unsuccessful in finding it earlier.”

“We actually don’t have a fragrance by—” Adora began, an expert on all their fragrances, but she froze as Catra’s words sunk in. *Truly* sunk in. “Oh,” was all her mouth was able to produce, staring at Catra with wide eyes.

Catra only smirked at her. “So, *Adora,”* the way she said her name, like a purr, made Adora’s heart skip, “can you help me?”

Adora swallowed. She had to be dreaming right now. Maybe she was actually back in bed at home, and none of this was actually happening. But Catra seemed real enough; the butterflies in Adora’s stomach seemed real enough.

“Yeah-yeah.” Adora smiled back, despite the nerves running rampant in her body, and quickly finished checking her out. It was a good thing it was a slow day and there was no one behind her, because Adora probably would’ve gotten complaints by now. Once the receipt was printed, Adora reached for a pen in her apron. She scribbled her number onto it, adding a small heart after a momentary pause, before folding the paper up neatly and placing it in Catra’s bag with her purchases.

She passed the bag over to Catra, who reached into it for the receipt. Had she been any other customer, Adora would've guessed she was just checking to make sure everything came out right, but that clearly wasn't the case.

"The heart's cute," Catra commented, and Adora flushed.

"You're cuter," Adora said before she could think twice. Catra just seemed to be enjoying the state Adora was currently in. "For a Horde student, anyway," she tacked on, even though that didn't make it better in the slightest.

Catra raised an eyebrow, the amusement in her expression growing. Adora could've sworn she saw a red tint on her cheeks, but it could have just been the lighting. "Bright Moon Donkey?"

"Stallion," Adora corrected with a scoff, rolling her eyes. She was aware of the running Horde joke to call Bright Moon's mascot a donkey because BMU students were asses—it wasn't true in the slightest; if anything, Horde students were the assholes.

Catra snorted. "Whatever you say, Princess. It's a good thing I don't give a shit about where you go, even if we are going to kick your asses this fall in football." She put the receipt back in her bag and flashed an almost evil (but so, so attractive) smirk at Adora. "I'll text you later. Thanks for all your help."

"Of course." Adora wiped her palms on her apron, which were sweaty. "I'll be waiting for your text."

Her eyes followed Catra as she turned and made her way to the front of the store. Distantly, she recalled what the girl had said just before leaving, something about football and kicking BMU's ass.

"I also wouldn't be too sure about this fall!" She called after Catra, ignoring the looks her coworkers and the few customers in the store gave her.

“Whatever helps you sleep at night,” Catra tossed over her shoulder. Adora couldn’t decide if she wanted to be offended or not that she didn’t even turn around to face Adora when she said it. Then again, her overall blasé demeanor was hot in a way that pissed Adora off.

When she got outside, turning the corner, Adora noticed her phone was out. Two minutes after she disappeared, Adora’s phone buzzed in her pocket.

“I better be invited to the wedding.” Adora turned her head to her right. Glimmer stood in front of the buy-online-pickup-in-store cart, a tablet balanced on her palm as she checked for orders to fill with a smirk on her face.

“I don’t know what you’re talking about.” Adora scowled at her and returned to the register, busying herself with tidying up the area to make it seem like she was doing something productive and didn’t care about Glimmer’s words one bit.

When she got off work a couple hours later, the first thing she did was check her phone, where a text from an unknown number was waiting for her.

Hey, Adora.

End Notes

If anyone's wondering, the word that inspired this fic was "fruity" (i think it's pretty obvious why). I just thought it was funny, pretty much. Originally, i was going to have adora say it (Catra would come up to her at the register to checkout and adora would be like "oh, fruity," about one of the items), but it obviously didn't work out like that. Instead, Adora is a flustered mess (same).

I have been in a bit of a writing slump lately. If you've read my fic, play me out (my pride and joy), and/or follow my tumblr (adorascake), you probably know that my next big project is a social media au. That is,,,coming along, but the process has been pretty slow, and now my brain is being occupied by a superhero au ive been wanting to write for a while. I want to work on one of them desperately, but its hard when ive been hit with so much writers block. Hopefully, that'll be over soon!

I hope y'all enjoyed this little one shot! Just FYI, comments give me life and inspiration to keep writing, and i love interacting with my followers on tumblr, so make sure you go follow me there<3

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!